

Clinical Case Packet — Oncology Prior Authorization Appeal

Riverside Oncology Group | Case Reference: APL-2026-00478

Member ID	MBR-441098	Date of Birth	1966-09-27
Member Name	Grace K. Delgado	Plan	Empire Advantage HMO
Requesting Provider	Dr. Samuel Torres, MD (Oncology)	NPI	1225580094

Diagnosis

C50.911 — Malignant neoplasm of unspecified site of right female breast, Stage IIB (T2N1M0), HER2-positive

Laboratory & Pathology Results

Date	Test	Result	Reference Range
2026-07-01	HER2 (IHC)	3+ (positive)	0 / 1+ negative
2026-07-01	ER/PR status	ER negative / PR negative	—
2026-07-03	CA 15-3	42 U/mL	0–30 U/mL
2026-07-08	CBC — WBC	6.1 x10 ⁹ /L	4.0–11.0 x10 ⁹ /L
2026-07-08	CBC — Hemoglobin	12.4 g/dL	12.0–15.5 g/dL
2026-07-08	LFT — ALT	28 U/L	7–56 U/L
2026-07-15	Cardiac ejection fraction (echo)	58%	≥50%

Treatment Request & Clinical Justification

Requesting prior authorization for trastuzumab deruxtecan (CPT J9358), 8 cycles, for HER2-positive Stage IIB breast cancer following disease progression on first-line trastuzumab/pertuzumab combination therapy (completed 2026-06-20). Imaging (MRI, 2026-06-28) confirmed a new 1.8cm axillary lymph node consistent with progression. Cardiac function remains within normal limits (EF 58%, see prior page), meeting eligibility criteria for HER2-directed antibody-drug conjugate therapy.

This request follows NCCN Category 1 guidelines for second-line treatment of HER2-positive metastatic or recurrent breast cancer. The denial letter (DEN-2026-20117, dated 2026-08-10) cited 'alternative first-line options not yet exhausted' — this is factually inconsistent with the treatment history documented above, and the appeal requests reconsideration on that basis.

Dr. Samuel Torres, MD — Medical Oncology — Riverside Oncology Group